

Elvis Rafael Gross Cardero

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud Operations Engineer with production experience in AWS and GCP, focused on infrastructure reliability, automation, and observability at enterprise scale. Delivered EKS operations, SSM-based patch management, and disaster recovery strategies across multi-account AWS environments supporting mission-critical workloads. Holds five active cloud and security certifications — AWS CloudOps, GCP PCA, GCP ACE, CompTIA Cloud+, and ISC2 CC — with CKA in progress. Brings a rare combination of hands-on infrastructure depth and GCP pre-sales architecture experience, making technical complexity accessible and actionable.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, EKS, SSM, CloudWatch, IAM, S3, RDS, CloudFormation, Auto Scaling), GCP (Cloud Run, BigQuery, Pub/Sub, Cloud Storage, Cloud Functions, IAM, CloudSQL)

DevOps & Infrastructure: Terraform, CloudFormation, Kubernetes (EKS, on-prem), Docker, Istio, Vagrant, KVM, Linux Virtualization, Golden AMI pipelines

Monitoring & Observability: CloudWatch (Metrics, Alarms, Dashboards, Log Insights, Container Insights), Prometheus, Grafana, LogicMonitor, AWS Systems Manager

Automation & Scripting: Bash, Python, AWS SSM Patch Manager, SSM Run Command, SSM Automation Documents, AWS CLI

Operations & Frameworks: Patch Management, Incident Response, DR Planning (RTO/RPO), FinOps, AWS Well-Architected Framework, NIST CSF

Databases: Amazon RDS, CloudSQL, SQL Server

OS / Platforms: Linux (RHEL, Rocky, Ubuntu), Windows Server

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cloud Operations Engineer | International Game Technology (IGT) | Las Vegas, NV *Mar 2025 – Apr 2026*

- Managed multi-account AWS environments supporting mission-critical gaming infrastructure, maintaining high availability and operational consistency across production workloads serving millions of end users.
- Designed and executed SSM Patch Manager workflows across fleets of Linux and Windows EC2 instances, enforcing patch compliance and reducing manual intervention in the patching lifecycle.
- Led EKS cluster version upgrades in production using a Golden AMI strategy — building validated, pre-hardened node images to minimize upgrade risk, reduce upgrade time, and ensure consistent baseline configurations across node groups.
- Implemented CloudWatch alarms, custom metrics, and log-based alerting to surface infrastructure anomalies before they impacted availability, reducing mean time to detection (MTTD) for production incidents.
- Designed and maintained backup and disaster recovery strategies aligned to defined RTO/RPO targets, including DR testing cycles and runbook documentation ensuring repeatable recovery procedures.
- Applied AWS Well-Architected Framework reviews across operational workloads to identify and remediate reliability, security, and cost optimization gaps.
- Used SSM Automation Documents and Run Command to automate routine operational tasks across instance fleets, reducing toil and improving operational consistency.

Pre-Sales Cloud Engineer | CODESA | Lima, Peru

Apr 2021 – Nov 2024

- Architected and presented production-ready GCP solutions for enterprise clients, designing scalable systems using Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, BigQuery, Cloud Functions, IAM, and Cloud Storage aligned to real business requirements.
- Built and executed end-to-end Proofs of Concept (PoCs) validating serverless and real-time data pipeline architectures, accelerating client cloud adoption and reducing time-to-close on technical evaluations.
- Designed secure IAM frameworks and real-time data pipeline architectures (Pub/Sub + BigQuery) as core components of client proposals, directly contributing to technical wins across the sales cycle.
- Delivered live technical workshops and architecture demos to enterprise stakeholders, translating complex GCP capabilities into clear business value propositions.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

EKS Production Upgrade Pipeline with Golden AMIs

- Built an EKS node upgrade workflow using custom Golden AMIs — pre-hardened with CloudWatch Agent, SSM Agent, and required tooling — to standardize node baseline configurations. Upgrade process included AMI validation, node group rotation with zero-downtime drain/cordon, and post-upgrade health checks via CloudWatch Container Insights.

Rocky Linux Custom AMI — AWS VM Import Pipeline

- Imported a custom Rocky Linux image into AWS EC2 via S3 VM Import/Export, configured CloudWatch Agent for metrics and log ingestion, and automated agent deployment across multiple instances through a bastion host — simulating an enterprise Golden AMI pipeline for non-marketplace OS images.

Kubernetes Homelab Cluster — CKA Preparation

- Provisioned a multi-node Kubernetes cluster from scratch using Vagrant and VirtualBox, covering CNI configuration, scheduling, RBAC, persistent storage, and pod lifecycle management. Purpose-built to develop production-grade operational skills ahead of CKA certification.

Windows LAPS 2024+ Proof of Concept on AWS

- Designed and tested a Windows Local Administrator Password Solution (LAPS) implementation on AWS EC2 Windows instances as a security hardening PoC, exploring integration with AWS Systems Manager Parameter Store for centralized password management and audit trail logging.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – CloudOps** — *Amazon Web Services*
- **Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect (PCA)** — *Google Cloud*
- **Google Cloud Associate Cloud Engineer (ACE)** — *Google Cloud*
- **CompTIA Cloud+ (CV0-004)** — *CompTIA*
- **ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)** — *ISC2*
- **CKA – Certified Kubernetes Administrator** — *CNCF | In Progress*

LICENSES

- **Nevada Gaming License** — *State of Nevada, Gaming Control Board*

EDUCATION

High School Equivalency (HSE) — *HiSET Examination*

LANGUAGES

Spanish (Native) • **English** (Full Professional) • **French** (Intermediate)